Michela Bonani

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Academic Positions

2023–present	Postdoctoral Researcher, Department of Economics and Business, Universitat Pompeu Fabra
March 2026 (scheduled)	Visiting Scholar, Platform Lab, Harvard Business School AI Institute, host: Chiara Farronato
2022–present	Research Affiliate, Department of Economics, ESSEC Business School
2017–present	Research Affiliate, Tilburg Law and Economics Center (TILEC), Tilburg University

Research Interests

Empirical Industrial Organization, Applied Microeconomics, Market Design

Education

2017–2023	**Ph.D. in Economics**, Tilburg University Advisors: Tobias J. Klein, Florian Schütt, and C.B.T. Walsh
2020	Visiting Ph.D. Student (planned), Searle Center, Northwestern University — cancelled due to COVID-19
2014	**M.Sc. in Economics and Social Sciences**, Bocconi University, Milan
2011	**B.Sc. in Management and Business Administration**, Bocconi University, Milan

Publications

Bonani, M. (2026). Standard-Setting and the Incentives to Innovate: Evidence from the IEEE Patent Policy Update. *International Journal of Industrial Organization*, 104, 103235.

Working Papers

Enabling the Unavailable Trip: Consumer Welfare and Willingness to Pay for Multimodal Technology, with J. Hidalgo **(Job Market Paper)**

Abstract: This paper studies how multimodal technologies affect consumer welfare by expanding the set of feasible transportation options. On transportation platforms, consumers may be unable to book their searched trip because the requested origin–destination pair is not served or because supply is unavailable at the time of booking. Multimodal technologies can relax these constraints by expanding the set of reachable destinations and by increasing the availability of transportation options across origin–destination pairs. However, the value of this technology depends on consumers' preferences for multimodal trips and on their willingness to pay for the resulting improvement in service. We develop an empirical model of transportation-mode choice across carpooling, buses, and an outside option on BlaBlaCar, the largest long-distance carpooling platform. Using proprietary BlaBlaCar data on passenger searches and bookings, together with information on the supply of BlaBlaCar cars and buses, we quantify consumers' disutility from not making the searched trip, measured by the distance (in km) between the searched and the booked origin–destination pairs. We use the estimated model to quantify consumers' value of multimodal technology and its implications for consumer surplus.

Uniform vs. Competing Standards: A Structural Analysis of the U.S. Wireless Telecommunications Industry *(submitted)*

Standardization and Patent Portfolios: Understanding Firms' Choices in Standard Projects

Work in Progress

Demand Estimation under Heterogeneous Dynamic Choice Sets and Forward-Looking Consumers, with J. Hidalgo

The Equilibrium Effects of Multimodal Technologies, with J. Hidalgo

Interoperability and Innovation: Evidence from the Digital Markets Act, with L. Lasio

Information, Price Commitment, and Entry in Peer-to-Peer Markets, with J. Gambato and L. Madio

Pre-Ph.D. Publications (in Italian)

Bonani, M. (2016). "Una nuova forma di impresa: la start-up innovativa." *I&C*, N. 8. Bruno Mondadori, Milan.

Bonani, M., and Mezza, L. (2015). "La performance delle imprese attraverso i dati di bilancio." In *Milano Produttiva 2015* (pp. 74–101). Bruno Mondadori, Milan.

Presentations

(* denotes discussant)

2026	Leuven Summer Event IO Workshop (KU Leuven); 3rd Mad–Bar IO Workshop*; DISS Online Workshop*; University of Bergamo Brown Bag (scheduled)
2025	2nd Padova IO Workshop (University of Padova); 2nd Mad–Bar IO Workshop (CEMFI); Jornadas de Economía Industrial (Santander); Fifth Annual Empirical Conference on Standardization (Northwestern Pritzker School of Law); UB 4th Microeconomics Workshop*
2024	IIOC (Boston); SWERIE IO Workshop (Stockholm School of Economics); FCC Economics Seminar; 6th ECOP Workshop; 7th UniBg IO Winter Symposium; PSE/ESSEC Workshop: Platforms, Mobility, and the Sharing Economy*; 1st Spanish IO Day*
2023	Third Annual Empirical Conference on Standardization (Northwestern Pritzker School of Law); Universitat Pompeu Fabra (Applied Lunch Seminar; Microeconomics Seminar); ESSEC Business School
2022	EARIE; Second Annual Empirical Conference on Standardization (Northwestern Pritzker School of Law); Universidad Carlos III de Madrid; Spring Meeting of Young Economists; CLEEN Conference; Copenhagen Business School; DICE Research Seminar; ZEW (Digital Economy Unit); Compass Lexecon; ESSEC Business School; Tilburg University (SEG Lunch; TILEC Seminar; Internal Workshop)
2021	CLEEN Conference; TILEC Workshop on the Economics of Patents and Standards; ENTER Jamboree*; Tilburg University (SEG Lunch; TILEC Seminar; Internal Workshop)
2018–2020	Tilburg University (SEG Lunch; TILEC Seminar; TILEC Annual Retreat; Internal Workshop)

Teaching

2026	Introduction to Game Theory (CRM), Barcelona School of Economics
2025	Introduction to Game Theory (CRM), TA for F. Germano, Barcelona School of Economics
2023	Business Economics (graduate), ESSEC Business School
2020–2022	Econometrics for ECO (undergraduate), TA for T.J. Klein, Tilburg University
2020	Data Communication for Policy Analysis (undergraduate), Lecturer, Tilburg University
2018–2020	Industrial Economics (undergraduate), TA for F. Schütt, E. Freddi, and E. Öztürk, Tilburg University

2017	Microeconomics: Theory and Analysis (undergraduate), TA for B. van Leeuwen and E. Freddi, Tilburg University
2017–2022	Supervision of undergraduate and master's theses, Tilburg University

Grants and Funding

2017–2023	Research grant, Tilburg Law and Economics Center (Qualcomm Inc. project)
2020	Mobility grant for research visit to the Searle Center, Northwestern University (EUR 3,000) — visit cancelled due to COVID-19

Professional Service

Service	Co-organizer, 7th Economics of Platforms Workshop, Barcelona Summer Forum (2025)
Refereeing	*Industrial and Corporate Change*; *Journal of Industrial and Business Economics*; European Association of Young Economists
Other Activities	Ph.D. Representative, Board of the Graduate Students' Society, Tilburg University (2018–2020)

Additional Training

2018	Dynamic Structural Econometrics Summer School, University of Copenhagen

Additional Information

Programming	Python, MATLAB, R, Stata, LaTeX
Languages	Italian (native), English (professional proficiency), Spanish (fluent)

References

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